Lab Sheet 5 — vi/vim Editor

Complete questions with answers immediately below each question. Commands are written for common Linux distributions; use sudo only when required.

Lab Sheet 5 — vi/vim Editor

distributions; use sudo only when required.

Lab Sheet 5 — vi/vim Editor

sudo only when required.

Question 1: Create a new file named lab5.txt using the vi/vim editor and enter at least five lines of text.

Answer / Solution:

```
vim lab5.txt; press i; enter five lines; press Esc; type :wq and press Enter.
```

Question 2: Open an existing file named lab5.txt using vi/vim and display its contents.

Answer / Solution:

```
vim lab5.txt; view the contents in Normal mode; :q to exit.
```

Question 3: Demonstrate switching between Normal mode, Insert mode and Command-Line mode in vi/vim.

Answer / Solution:

```
Normal mode: Esc; Insert mode: i; Command-Line mode: : then type a command and Enter.
```

Question 4: Insert new text before and after the current cursor position and verify the changes.

Answer / Solution:

```
Press i to insert before the cursor; press a to insert after the cursor; press Esc and inspect the line.
```

Question 5: Add a new line below the current line and another new line above the current line using vi/vim commands.

Answer / Solution:

```
Press o to open a new line below; press O to open a new line above; type text and press Esc.
```

Question 6: Save the current file without exiting vi/vim.

Answer / Solution:

```
Press Esc, type :w, then Enter.
```

Question 7: Save the current file and exit vi/vim using the appropriate command.

Answer / Solution:

```
Press Esc, type :wq, then Enter.
```

Question 8: Exit vi/vim without saving the changes made to a file.

Answer / Solution:

```
Press Esc, type :q!, then Enter (discard unsaved changes).
```

Question 9: Move the cursor to the beginning and end of a line using vi/vim commands.

Answer / Solution:

```
0 moves to the first column; $ moves to the end of the line.
```

Question 10: Move the cursor to the beginning and end of the file using vi/vim commands.

Answer / Solution:

```
gg moves to the first line; G moves to the last line.
```

Question 11: Delete a character, a word and a complete line using appropriate vi/vim commands.

Answer / Solution:

```
x deletes a character; dw deletes a word; dd deletes a line.
```

Question 12: Copy the current line and paste it below the current line.

Answer / Solution:

```
yy copies the current line; p pastes it below.
```

Question 13: Copy multiple lines and paste them at another location in the file.

Answer / Solution:

```
Use 3yy to copy three lines; move to destination and press p.
```

Question 14: Search forward for a specified word in the file and move between matching occurrences.

Answer / Solution:

```
Type /word and press Enter to search forward; n goes to next match, N to previous.
```

Question 15: Search backward for a specified word in the file and move between matching occurrences.

Answer / Solution:

```
Type ?word and press Enter to search backward; n repeats backward, N goes the opposite direction.
```

Question 16: Replace the first occurrence of a specified word on the current line using vi/vim.

Answer / Solution:

```
Use :s/old/new/ and press Enter to replace the first occurrence on the current line.
```

Question 17: Replace all occurrences of a specified word throughout the file using a suitable substitution command.

Answer / Solution:

```
Use :%s/old/new/g and press Enter to replace every occurrence in the file (add c for confirmation: :%s/
old/new/gc).
```

Question 18: Undo the last change and then redo the change using vi/vim commands.

Answer / Solution:

```
u undoes the last change; Ctrl+r redoes it.
```

Question 19: Use line numbers to display the current line number and jump directly to a specified line.

Answer / Solution:

```
:set number displays line numbers; :5 jumps to line 5 (or type 5G).
```

Question 20: Create, edit, search, replace, copy, paste, save and exit a text file using vi/vim as a complete workflow.

Answer / Solution:

```
Workflow: vim lab5.txt; i to type; Esc; /word to search; :%s/old/new/g to replace; yy and p to copy/
paste; :w to save; :q to
exit.
```